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NEWSLETTERS June 17, 2023 • No comments

Economics Newsletter – June 16, 2023

New UWES articles, CPI data, and more!

Written By: Benjamin Pipicelli, Lexx Thomson, & Dorje Gyaltsen

Economics Newsletter – June 16, 2023

Author's Commentary

Canadian Labour Market in May

In Canada, the unemployment rate rose from 5 to 5.2% this May, marking the highest increase since October. This increase was fueled mainly by the 15-24-year-old age category. Which often displays volatility leading up to the start of summer due to the timing of holidays and how readily available summer jobs are. The unemployment rate for prime-aged workers (25-54) actually saw the strongest increase in employment since January (+21k).

Full-time employment drove the decline in overall job count, with part-time actually slightly up. By class of worker, all of the declines in the jobs count came within self-employed, with both private and public paid employment up compared to the prior month.

Most analysts believe this week's "weaker than expected" headlines have been exaggerated by youth employment. Forecasting one more 25bp hike from the Bank of Canada before the fall. However, with past interest rate hikes continuing to lower demand within the economy, months of either weak job growth or modest declines will likely become more common in the second half of the year, seeing the unemployment rate move up further and helping to cool wage inflation.

News and Noteworthy

Canadian Mortgage Growth Is Weakest in 20 Years Amid High Rates

Households added a net CAD \$11.2 billion (\$8.4 billion) in mortgage debt in the first three months of the year, according to national balance sheet data released Wednesday by Statistics Canada. That's the smallest increase in two decades. The report suggests higher borrowing costs are weighing on many households' ability to access credit, though residential real estate prices recovered during the quarter as inventory remained constrained. The slowdown in the net growth in mortgage debt coincides with one of the Bank of Canada's most aggressive ever campaigns to raise to borrowing costs. After declaring a conditional pause in January, policymakers boosted the benchmark overnight rate to 4.75% last week as household expenditures continued to grow. [Read more.](#)

Ballard Power rethinking \$130M China investment plan amid geopolitical risk

Canadian fuel cell-maker Ballard Power Systems is rethinking a \$130 million investment in China, gauging the risk of a "geopolitical collapse" as tensions rise. Speaking at Ballard's investor day on Tuesday, CEO Randy MacEwen said he is working with the consulting firm Deloitte to compare Ballard's current investment plans in China against potential opportunities in Europe and the United States "to see whether that should be revisited." "On the one side, you've had delays and uncertainties on the China policies, and you had a heightened geopolitical environment. At the same time, you've seen policies emerge in the U.S. and Europe supporting the adoption of hydrogen, supporting the adoption of fuel-cell vehicles, and supporting domestic manufacturing across the hydrogen and fuel-cell value chain," MacEwen said Tuesday. [Read more.](#)

Almost 30% of Canadians expect they will never retire, Yahoo/Maru survey shows

As the cost of living soars in Canada, nearly one in three Canadians say they do not expect to be able to retire. That's according to a new Yahoo/Maru Public Opinion survey of 846 working Canadian adults. The survey found that 28 per cent of Canadians who are currently working say they don't ever expect to retire. Those earning less than \$50,000 are the most pessimistic about the possibility of retiring, with 39 per cent saying they expect never to retire. The survey found that 27 per cent of those making between \$50,000 and \$100,000 expect not to retire, while 16 per cent of those making over \$100,000 expect they will not retire. [Read more.](#)

Why the Bank of Canada rate hike won't be one and done

More pain is on the way for indebted Canadian households, but they might be able to take some cold comfort that interest rates could soon peak, according to Bay Street economists. "The Bank of Canada did tell us that it basically lost confidence that the current level of interest rates was enough to get inflation back to 2%. It's hard to see how a single 25 basis point hike would change that view. So I think most people now, certainly our forecast, is that the bank will hike again in July," Stephen Brown, deputy chief North America economist at Capital Economics, said in a phone interview. He sees the Bank's benchmark rate topping out at five per cent as more data roll in through the summer about how businesses and consumers are handling higher rates. [Read more.](#)

Tesla robotaxis to 'transform society more than anything else': RBC

Tesla's plan to develop a fully-driverless taxi without pedals or a steering wheel has prompted RBC Capital Markets to raise its price target on the company's shares by more than 40 per cent. In a note to clients on Thursday, analyst Tom Narayan predicted "robotaxis" and autonomous vehicles in general could "transform society more than anything else in our lifetimes," saving "millions of lives and trillions of hours." He raised his price target on Nasdaq-listed Tesla shares (TSLA) from US \$212 to US \$305, while maintaining an "outperform" rating. CEO Elon Musk has said a robotaxi will be ready for launch in 2024, his latest timeline for an autonomous ride-sharing vehicle originally planned to hit the market in 2020. His envisions a cheaper cost per mile than public transportation. [Read more.](#)

Economics Society News, Events, and Articles

- Keep an eye out on our Instagram page @UWEconSoc for updates regarding future events
- Our weekly Economics Study Lounge has begun! Come to HH2034 Project Cube every Monday from 6:30-8:30pm!
- Check out our latest original article, *Breaking Down Barriers: Effective Solutions for Addressing Ethnolinguistic Fractionalization in Côte d'Ivoire* written by Sneha Elavarasan!
- Please view our updated Stock Contest rankings below! If you have any questions or concerns, please DM us on our Instagram page

Place	Name	Stock names	Total gain/loss
1	Akshayan.j	Upstart Holdings Inc. CARVANA CO., THE TRADE DESK. INC.	58.54%
2	elipropp	ANAERGIA INC., POOL CORPORATION. ALPHABET INC.	41.77%
3	jnewand	ANAERGIA INC., Algonquin Power & Utilities Corp., THE HOME	38.04%
4	leon.l8	TESLA, INC., TESLA, INC., TESLA, INC.	32.47%
5	dev._parikh	TESLA, INC., APPLE INC., CCL PRODUCTS (INDIA) LIMITED	31.91%
6	Ivanhe9	PALANTIR TECHNOLOGIES INC., C3.AI, INC., TESLA, INC.	31.32%
7	1zubair207	Upstart Holdings Inc. BLOCK, INC., PALANTIR TECHNOLOGIES	30.77%
8	pivato.investing	TESLA, INC., BEYOND MEAT, INC., PALANTIR TECHNOLOGIES	27.35%
9	nick_smith1219	TESLA, INC., PALANTIR TECHNOLOGIES INC., PALANTIR	27.02%
10	fbroham	NVIDIA CORPORATION. GSI TECHNOLOGY, INC., SUPER MICRO	26.80%
11	nicholas._chow	TESLA, INC., Teladoc Health, Inc., ROKU, INC.	23.87%
12	afridi_hesham	Upstart Holdings Inc. DELTA AIR LINES, INC., ZIM INTEGRATED	22.40%
13	1zubair207	PAYPAL HOLDINGS, INC., PALANTIR TECHNOLOGIES INC., TESLA	22.40%
14	Al1ahyar	TESLA, INC., AMAZON.COM, INC., Meta Platforms, Inc.	22.16%
15	zan_tao	TESLA, INC., Meta Platforms, Inc., APPLE INC.	19.71%
16	s532sing@uwaterloo.ca	PLUG POWER INC., SUNRUN INC., Blackstone Inc	19.52%
17	umer.t7	APPLE INC., TESLA, INC., TESLA, INC.	19.25%
18	ishaandani.13	TESLA, INC., AMAZON.COM, INC., APPLE INC.	19.19%
19	Stoobert1	TESLA, INC., APPLE INC., TWILIO INC.	18.76%
20	patriciachen__	COSTCO WHOLESALE CORPORATION. TESLA, INC., CANADA	17.86%
21	ethanh812	AIRBNB, INC., ALPHABET INC., TESLA, INC.	17.74%
22	Kashish.arora_	TESLA, INC., ALPHABET INC., AT & S Austria Technologie &	17.22%
23	brendans125	ROBLOX CORPORATION. COINBASE GLOBAL, INC., Upstart	16.06%
24	Ty.rizzle	APPLE INC., TESLA, INC., AMC ENTERTAINMENT HOLDINGS	15.96%
25	sumeetdhatt_	APPLE INC., TESLA, INC., THE TORONTO-DOMINION BANK	15.29%
26	gggrace6_	AIRBNB, INC., W.I.S.E.-NdaqOsChNwEcCoTp50Trk, W.I.S.E.-	15.07%
27	cwinch28	MATTERPORT, INC., NVIDIA CORPORATION. PALANTIR	14.93%
28	aayushituli	TESLA, INC., ALPHABET INC., MICROSOFT CORPORATION	14.06%
29	dasarathymutharasan	TESLA, INC., ALPHABET INC., WALMART INC.	13.96%
30	@Kayen.m	TESLA, INC., APPLE INC., Aritzia Inc.	13.62%
31	Aymantawfee01	TESLA, INC., Meta Platforms, Inc., AMAZON.COM, INC.	13.35%
32	rubenben10	NVIDIA CORPORATION. TESLA, INC., CLEANSARK, INC.	13.29%
33	nimisha_robin	APPLE INC., TESLA, INC., ALPHABET INC.	12.82%
34	hoseradishes.w	ASML Holding NV, C3.AI, INC., ADVANCED MICRO DEVICES, INC.	12.66%
35	matte_tru	AMMO, INC., Glorv Star New Media Group Holdings Limited,	11.27%
36	john.yung_	LITTELFUSE, INC., PALANTIR TECHNOLOGIES INC., EPR	11.24%
37	sidxg	ContextLogic Inc, TESLA, INC., GAMESTOP CORP.	10.98%
38	Test123	TOUCHSTAR PLC, TOUCHSTAR PLC, TOUCHSTAR PLC	10.26%
39	elvmctavish	NVIDIA CORPORATION. NVIDIA CORPORATION. NVIDIA	9.52%
40	leoliu740	THE WALT DISNEY COMPANY. TRINSEO PUBLIC LIMITED	9.12%
41	lukas_wormald	LITHIA MOTORS, INC., DATADOG, INC., WELLTOWER INC.	9.01%
42	hyunbeen.kim	JinkoSolar Holding Co., Ltd., CHENIERE ENERGY, INC., CENTRUS	8.21%
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48		Hut 8 Mining Corp., Bitfarms Ltd., NIO INC.	7.53%
48	mccowanzhang		
49	ppieroc	NVIDIA CORPORATION, MICROSOFT CORPORATION, Alibaba	7.42%
50	dqmfx02	THE CHEMOURS COMPANY. MERCK & CO., INC., AMERICAN	7.30%
51	Kokaine kola	BUILD-A-BEAR WORKSHOP, INC., GAMESTOP CORP., BUILD-A-	7.01%
52	queen__friday	CELESTICA INC., DOLLARAMA INC., BANK OF MONTREAL	6.94%
53	Jamie_Kibel	3M COMPANY, NVIDIA CORPORATION. MICROSOFT	6.94%
54	Rin_Kamuraito	AMAZON.COM, INC., BERKSHIRE HATHAWAY INC., THE PNC	6.78%
55	@ccompsci	FIVE BELOW, INC., THE HOME DEPOT, INC., APPLE INC.	6.69%
56	rchang.45	AIRBNB, INC., Obsidian Energy Ltd., SUNCOR ENERGY INC.	6.50%
57	vivan.garg	BLOCK, INC., MICRON TECHNOLOGY, INC., Alibaba Group	6.39%
58	peterhong0803	UBER TECHNOLOGIES, INC., 8X8, INC., 8X8, INC.	6.36%
59	w327chen@uwaterloo.ca	CONOCOPHILLIPS. AMAZON.COM, INC., UNITED AIRLINES	6.29%
60	rohaanms	AMAZON.COM, INC., NVIDIA CORPORATION. MICROSOFT	6.07%
61	kevin.lu	THE MOSAIC COMPANY, NVIDIA CORPORATION, ZOETIS INC.	5.82%
62	ethanafraser	THE WALT DISNEY COMPANY, BERKSHIRE HATHAWAY INC.,	5.81%
63	snehafrme	PINTEREST, INC., LULULEMON ATHLETICA INC., LVMH Moet	5.64%
64	ahmedirr	AMAZON.COM, INC., MICROSOFT CORPORATION, APPLE INC.	5.56%
65	Srishti__s	CANADA GOOSE HOLDINGS INC., IAMGOLD CORPORATION.	5.55%
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67	v37shah@uwaterloo.ca	APPLE INC., NVIDIA CORPORATION. ALPHABET INC.	5.28%
68	_dominicdecoco_	NVIDIA CORPORATION. Meta Platforms, Inc., AMERICAN	5.04%
69	ariel.gans	MICROSOFT CORPORATION. PFIZER INC., FB Financial	4.88%
70	josh_jag123	BERKSHIRE HATHAWAY INC., OCCIDENTAL PETROLEUM	4.55%
71	selvin_wen	BANK OF MONTREAL, APPLE INC., VISA INC.	4.52%
72	adi.k73	MP MATERIALS CORP. TSX-Toronto Stock Exchange 300	4.51%
73	arhansolo	NVIDIA CORPORATION, APPLE INC., ADVANCED MICRO	4.50%
74	aarushjain07	CANADIAN IMPERIAL BANK OF COMMERCE, CRANE COMPANY,	4.49%
75	Hanz.vora	Lightspeed Commerce Inc., HIVE Blockchain Technologies Ltd.,	4.33%
76	markghazi	APPLE INC., AMAZON.COM, INC., ALPHABET INC.	4.25%
77	aryanchopraa	AMAZON.COM, INC., HONEYWELL INTERNATIONAL INC.,	3.92%
78	@queen__friday	CELESTICA INC., Enbridge Inc., Canadian National Railway	3.82%
79	shxrey04	Pan American Silver Corp., Enbridge Inc., INTERNATIONAL	3.72%
80	Lachlanwashere	AMAZON.COM, INC., ALPHABET INC., Meta Platforms, Inc.	3.68%
81	N/A	ADVANCED MICRO DEVICES, INC., NVIDIA CORPORATION, Nano	3.66%
82	chxwmoh	EQT CORPORATION, OCCIDENTAL PETROLEUM CORPORATION,	3.64%
83	gaurav__shah	Constellation Software Inc., MICROSOFT CORPORATION.	3.63%
84	max.korsunsky	ALPHABET INC., MICROSOFT CORPORATION, ROYAL BANK OF	3.40%
85	alec.2310	TSX-Toronto Stock Exchange 300 Composite Index.	3.32%
86	hardhikdaddy	APPLE INC., AMAZON.COM, INC., ALPHABET INC.	3.12%
87	fbroham	Post Holdings, Inc., MCDONALD'S CORPORATION. CHESAPEAKE	3.07%
88	squirejetpack	TOURMALINE OIL CORP., OVINTIV INC., SUNCOR ENERGY INC.	2.70%
89	akshaykumar	CHRYSLER CORPORATION, SUNCOR ENERGY INC., THE HOME	2.54%

89	anadeepdas_	CHEVRON CORPORATION, SUNCOR ENERGY INC., THE HOME	2.51%
90	sandheep_s	APPLE INC., JOHNSON & JOHNSON, Nasdaq, Inc.	2.39%
91	euan.lawrence	APPLE INC., Nasdaq, Inc., THE BOEING COMPANY	1.69%
92	Yigit459	Alibaba Group Holding Limited, COINBASE GLOBAL, INC.,	1.44%
93	ningya.shen	ADVANCED MICRO DEVICES, INC., CISCO SYSTEMS, INC., VISA	0.82%
94	nathandopko	AMAZON.COM, INC., THE GEO GROUP, INC., ALAMOS GOLD	0.70%
95	cwinch28	TWITTER, INC., RIOCAN REAL ESTATE TRST UNT. THE BANK OF	0.38%
96	aryan_parikh	ADVANCED MICRO DEVICES, INC., COHEN DEVELOPMENT GAS	0.04%
97	kokainekola	GAMESTOP CORP., BED BATH & BEYOND INC., BUILD-A-BEAR	-0.42%
98	amritganju	VERTEX ENERGY, INC., BEACH ENERGY LIMITED, TRINSEO	-1.44%
99	saarang26	APPLE INC., Nasdaq, Inc., Nasdaq, Inc.	-1.47%
100	Agamdeep_sk	ALPHABET INC., COINBASE GLOBAL, INC., COINBASE GLOBAL,	-2.20%
101	ItsSujee	LOBLAW COMPANIES LIMITED, LOBLAW COMPANIES LIMITED,	-2.71%
102	Rin_Kamuraito	AMAZON.COM, INC., AdvsrShs Ranger Eatv Br, ROYAL BANK OF	-3.26%
103	amritganju	BEACH ENERGY LIMITED, VERTEX ENERGY, INC., Obsidian	-6.41%
104	amritganju	VERTEX ENERGY, INC., BEACH ENERGY LIMITED, TRINSEO	-6.47%
105	elijahfarley	FAZE HOLDINGS INC., FAZE HOLDINGS INC., FAZE HOLDINGS	-13.84%
106	dev._parikh	BED BATH & BEYOND INC., AMC ENTERTAINMENT HOLDINGS,	-14.00%

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